

# International Student Job Manual

## Part-time Work & Employment Guide for Students in Korea

For D-2 (student) & D-4 (language) visa holders — allowed hours, rules, penalties, and post-graduation job paths

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### Student Visa Sub-statuses (D-2)

| Code  | Name           | Description                                              |
|-------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| D-2-1 | Junior College | 2~3-year professional-degree program                     |
| D-2-2 | Bachelor's     | 4-year undergraduate program                             |
| D-2-3 | Master's       | Graduate master's program                                |
| D-2-4 | Doctoral       | Graduate doctoral program                                |
| D-2-5 | Research       | Research course/student (1 yr at a time, no stay >2 yrs) |
| D-2-6 | Exchange       | Exchange student                                         |
| D-2-7 | Work-Study     | Work-study linked program                                |
| D-2-8 | Visiting       | Visiting student (part-time work only after 6 months)    |

### Language / Language-Learning (D-4) Sub-statuses

| Code  | Name                      | Description                                                                                                                           |
|-------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D-4-1 | Korean Language           | Korean-language training at a university-affiliated language center                                                                   |
| D-4-2 | General Training          | Education/training or research at institutions, companies, or organizations other than D-2-eligible educational/research institutions |
| D-4-3 | Under-High-School Student | International student below high-school level (elementary/middle/high school)                                                         |
| D-4-5 | Cuisine Trainee           | Korean-cuisine training (Sura School internship only)                                                                                 |
| D-4-6 | Private Institution       | Excellent private-institution training (20+ months)                                                                                   |
| D-4-7 | Foreign Language          | Foreign-language training                                                                                                             |

## 1. Part-Time Work — Basic Rules

**General principle:** limited to ordinary part-time student activity (simple labor, etc.) per Immigration Act Enforcement Decree Annex 1-2. Private tutoring is strictly restricted due to place/target characteristics.

**Who qualifies:** those with a certain level of Korean ability, focused on study, with confirmation from their university's international-student office.

- D-2-1~D-2-4, D-2-6, D-2-7 (student statuses) — see start rules below
- D-4-1/D-4-7 (language) and D-2-8 (visiting) — allowed only after 6 months from change date (entry date for visa holders)
- Excluded: those granted exceptional stay due to unmet graduation requirements (except master's/PhD thesis students, capped at 30h/week, no unlimited holiday rule)
- Restricted: average GPA below C (2.0) in the previous semester, or language students with overall attendance below 90%; or penalized for permit violation in the last 3 months

### Allowed hours (weekday basis)

| Level             | Korean req                               | Weekday              | Holidays/vacation | Accredited univ |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| Junior college    | TOPIK 3 / KIIP st3 (61pt) / Sejong mid-1 | not met 10h, met 25h | Unlimited         | 30h             |
| Bachelor's 1-2 yr | -                                        | not met 10h, met 25h | Unlimited         | 30h             |
| Bachelor's 3-4 yr | TOPIK 4 / KIIP st4 (81pt) / Sejong mid-2 | not met 10h, met 25h | Unlimited         | 30h             |
| Master's/PhD      | -                                        | not met 15h, met 30h | Unlimited         | 35h             |

**English-track note:** TOEFL 530 (CBT197/iBT71), IELTS 5.5, CEFR B2, TEPS 601 (NEW TEPS 327) certificate holders qualify; English-native countries exempt from cert submission.

### When work can start

| Status                   | When part-time allowed                   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| D-2-1 (Junior College)   | Immediately                              |
| D-2-2 (Bachelor's)       | Immediately                              |
| D-2-3 (Master's)         | Immediately                              |
| D-2-4 (Doctoral)         | Immediately                              |
| D-2-6 (Exchange)         | Immediately                              |
| D-2-7 (Work-Study)       | Immediately                              |
| D-2-5 (Research)         | Not part-time eligible (research status) |
| D-2-8 (Visiting)         | 6 months after change/entry date         |
| D-4-1 / D-4-7 (Language) | 6 months after change/entry date         |

**Duration & places:** D-2 = max 1 year, up to 2 workplaces simultaneously. D-4 = max 6 months, 1 workplace.

### Restricted work fields

- Activities contrary to public decency or social order (Immigration Act Enforcement Rule art. 27-2(2)).
- Professional-field (E-1~E-7) scope incl. conversation instruction (E-2) at minor-targeted foreign-language facilities.
- E-9 manufacturing/construction and E-10 seafarer work (manufacturing allowed if TOPIK 4+).
- Special-form laborers: couriers, delivery riders, designated drivers, insurance planners, home-visit tutors, door-to-door sales.
- Employment via dispatch/contract/agency (except internship placement by universities designated by the MOJ).
- Remote work.
- Work at employers restricted from visa issuance due to past illegal-employment penalties.

### Exceptions (allowed under conditions)

- Manufacturing: if TOPIK 4 or equivalent.
- Safety/play assistants at English kid-cafes/camps and minor-targeted foreign-language facilities.
- Part-time or full-time seasonal work.
- Assistance in professional fields (E-1~E-7, excluding E-6-2).

- Internship in professional fields (E-1~E-7) for work-study students.
- Professional-field internship (E-1~E-7) during vacations for degree students.
- Even when part-time work is professional-field (E-1~E-7) assistance/internship, licensed occupations still require meeting the legal qualification.

#### Required documents

- Application, passport, alien registration card (fee waived).
- Grade or attendance certificate (waived if verifiable via the student info system).
- Korean (or English) proficiency proof.
- International-student part-time-work confirmation.
- Part-time-work requirement compliance form (only if business registration includes manufacturing/construction).
- Business registration copy and employer ID copy.
- Standard employment contract copy (must state hourly wage, duties, hours).
- Direct contract with the business principal; no split employment via staffing agencies.

#### Penalties for violation

- Work without permit - 1st offense: notice & stay granted if minor; construction-sector illegal work = departure order (no exception).
- Work without permit - 2nd offense: forced deportation.
- Permit granted but condition violated - 1st: severe warning.
- Condition violated - 2nd: no part-time work during study.
- Condition violated - 3rd: student status revoked.

## 2. Employment After Graduation

| From                                 | To                                   | Condition                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D-4-6 (domestic training 20+ months) | E-7 Specific Activity                | Overseas jr-college or higher + domestic training (D-4-6, 20+ months) completed + national certificate + KIIP stage 4; intended job is professional/technical & related to training field |
| D-2 Student                          | E-7 Specific Activity (professional) | Graduate + employment confirmed → change immediately                                                                                                                                      |
| D-2 Student                          | D-10 Job-seeking                     | Not yet employed after graduation (max 2 yrs)                                                                                                                                             |
| D-2 Student                          | F-2-7 Resident (points)              | Meet points-based residence criteria                                                                                                                                                      |
| D-2 Student                          | F-5 Permanent                        | Long-term stay & PR criteria                                                                                                                                                              |
| E-9 Non-professional                 | E-7-4 Skilled worker                 | 5+ yrs work (4 yrs + KIIP stage 3)                                                                                                                                                        |
| E-9 Non-professional                 | F-2 Resident                         | Long-term stay criteria                                                                                                                                                                   |
| E-9 Non-professional                 | F-5 Permanent                        | Long-term stay criteria                                                                                                                                                                   |
| D-2 Student                          | E-7 Specific Activity                | Graduate + employment confirmed → change immediately                                                                                                                                      |
| D-4 Language                         | D-2 Student                          | Enter a degree program in Korea → change before term starts                                                                                                                               |

#### E-7 eligible occupations (94)

Professional (E-7-1): 67 occupations — managers 15, professionals & related 52. Semi-professional (E-7-2): 10 (office 5, service 5). General skilled (E-7-3). Skilled-worker (E-7-4): 7. Negative-list system. Also: E-7-5 high-income & advanced-industry, E-7-6 best talent, E-7-7 advanced-industry & best talent. (Details per MOJ occupation table.)

#### E-7-4 Skilled Worker

| Target                                                                                                               | Requirement                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Root-industry skilled (S740), agriculture/forestry/fishery (S610), general manufacturing/construction skilled (S700) | Skilled-worker points system; 2026 wage threshold KRW 26M+/yr |

### 3. Key Notes

- Part-time-work special rule: incidental gratuities, prize money, or payment for activities not infringing the essence of student status are exempt from the permit requirement.
- Paid research (D-2): study-linked research/internship within your university = exempt. Unrelated research = permit needed. Off-campus study-linked = permit needed; off-campus unrelated = status-outside-activity permit (E-3).
- Field-work semester: standard/mandatory field-work curricula are exempt; voluntary field work needs the permit.
- D-2 stay-extension caps: jr-college 3 yrs (3-yr: 4), bachelor's 6 (5-yr: 7), master's 5 (3-yr: 6), PhD 8 (2-yr: 7).
- Re-entry permit exemption: re-entering within 1 year of departure is exempt; between 1-2 years, apply for a multiple re-entry permit.
- E-7 special for excellent-private-institution trainees: D-4-6 (20+ months) + national certificate + KIIP stage 4 → E-7 in the trained field (except E-7-4).